

Component 2 – requirements for design skills				
Requirements	Costume design	Lighting design	Set design	Sound design
Design skills	Mono or duo: Final costume designs for one character, incorporating hair, makeup and mask considerations as appropriate. All sourcing must be based wholly on the student's design(s).	Mono or duo: Final lighting design incorporating grid plans and a lantern schedule that indicates the use of two different lighting states.	Mono or duo: Drawings of the final design to be realised in the performance space and any relevant props.	Mono or duo: Source sheet showing two sound cues – original, live or found sound effects as appropriate.
	Group: Final costume designs for two different characters, incorporating hair, makeup and mask considerations as appropriate. All sourcing must be based wholly on the student's design(s).	Group: Final lighting design incorporating grid plans and a lantern schedule that indicates the use of three different lighting states.	Group: 1:25 scale model of the final design to be realised in the performance space and any props as appropriate.	Group: Source sheet showing three sound effects – original, live or found sound effects as appropriate.
Additional documentation	For both performances: a costume plot or list of costumes/accessories worn by each actor indicating any changes as appropriate.	For both performances: a lighting plot or cue sheet incorporating a range of transitional devices as appropriate.	For both performances: a ground plan of the performance space to scale, including entrances and exits, audience positioning and stage furniture (as appropriate).	For both performances: a cue sheet showing the source, order, length and output level of each cue.
Supervision	The student must supervise the construction, buying, dyeing altering, hiring and/or finding of the designed costumes as appropriate.	The student must supervise the rigging, focusing, programming (if applicable) and operating of the design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the construction, painting, hiring and/or finding of scenic elements required to meet the requirements of their design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the operation of the sound as appropriate but need not operate the sound themselves.
Performance	A realisation of the costume design in both performances.	A realisation of the lighting design in both performances.	A realisation of the set design in both performances.	A realisation of the sound design in both performances.
NB: Centres are reminded that any appropriate evidence produced in line with the requirements above should also be made available to the visiting examiner when they make their visit.				

Assessment information

This component is externally assessed by a visiting examiner or by an examiner assessing the recorded live performance. It is worth 60 marks and AO2 is assessed.

First assessment: 2018

The performances **must** be recorded by the centre and unedited. Please refer to *Appendix 4: Best practice when recording performance*. This recorded evidence is to be sent to the examiner.

The monologue or duologue performance/design realisation is worth 24 marks. AO2 is assessed.

The group performance/design realisation is worth 36 marks. AO2 is assessed.

A realisation of each design candidate's work must be seen and assessed in both performances.

Teachers cannot give support and guidance during the performances.

All centres must provide the following information to their examiner before their examination:

- a declaration that all key extracts studied by students meet the requirements to be from a scene or a moment that is significant to the text as a whole and at least 10 minutes in length when performed.
- indication of group numbers and performance lengths
- character/design role information for each student to be assessed
- the performance texts chosen for Component 1 and 3 (in order for the different text requirement to be checked)
- a brief explanation by each student of the intention for each performance or design (150–250 words per key extract studied).

The explanation must include the following:

- for performance students (150–250 words per character played)
 - what role(s) are you playing?
 - what is happening to your character(s) in the key extract?
 - how does the key extract relate to the context of the whole play?
 - what are your character's objectives/motivations/feelings?
 - how are you interpreting this character(s) in performance? (i.e. vocal, physical, communication of intent)
- for design students (150–250 words per extract designed for)
 - what design role are you fulfilling?
 - what is your central design concept in the key extract?
 - how does the key extract relate to the context of the whole play?
 - how have you interpreted this key extract through your design?
 - what are you hoping to communicate to the audience?

Performers will be assessed on their ability to realise artistic intentions through the:

- use of vocal and physical skills
- use of characterisation and communication
- interpretation of text.

Designers will be assessed on their ability to realise artistic intentions through the:

- use of design skills
- understanding of context and communication
- interpretation of text.

Non-assessed individuals

Non-assessed individuals should be used **only** when:

- the total number of students in the cohort does not meet the minimum group size requirement
- a student has withdrawn from the performance near to the assessment date
- a student is absent on the day of the assessment.

Non-assessed individuals may be used to read out the lines of the absent student(s) to support the performance group. Please note that a non-assessed individual may be a class peer, student from a different year group or a member of staff. Assessed and non-assessed individuals must be clearly identified at the start of the recorded evidence to aid assessment.

Permission must be sought from Pearson in advance for the inclusion of non-assessed individuals. Please email your requests to drama.assessment@pearson.com and upload a copy of the confirmation approval email to Learner Work Transfer when submitting assessment materials.

Non-examination Assessment criteria

Examiners will use the following assessment criteria to mark students' work. Each mark grid identifies which Assessment Objective is being targeted.

Assessment criteria for group performance: performers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group performance – vocal and physical skills (performers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited - Performance is often inappropriate or inconsistent, showing a lack of variety, range and control, with superficial understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Basic technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Limited technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).
Level 2	3–4	General - Performance is generally appropriate and consistent, showing emerging variety, range and control, with generally appropriate understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Generally sound technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Generally sound technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).
Level 3	5–7	Competent - Performance is appropriate and consistent, showing clear variety, range and control, with competent understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Competent technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Competent technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).
Level 4	8–10	Assured - Performance is pertinent and comprehensive, showing effective variety, range and control throughout, with confident understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Assured technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Assured technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group performance – vocal and physical skills (performers)
Level 5	11–12	Sophisticated • Performance is perceptively integrated, sophisticated and dynamic, showing skilful variety, range and control throughout, with an accomplished understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. • Accomplished technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). • Sophisticated technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group performance – characterisation and communication (performers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited • Characterisation demonstrates a basic understanding of the role and its context within the performance, showing limited credibility and consistency. • Characterisation lacks clarity, with obvious lapses in focus and confidence. • Superficial rapport and inconsistent communication with audience/other performers shown through lack of ease and awareness.
Level 2	3–4	General • Characterisation demonstrates a generally sound understanding of the role and its context within the performance, showing emerging credibility and consistency. • Characterisation is generally clear, showing emerging focus and confidence. • Generally sound rapport and communication with audience/other performers, shown through emerging ease and awareness.
Level 3	5–7	Competent • Characterisation demonstrates a competent understanding of the role and its context within the performance, shown by clear credibility and consistency. • Characterisation is sustained, showing clear focus and confidence. • Clear rapport and communication with audience/other performers, shown through secure ease and awareness.
Level 4	8–10	Assured • Characterisation demonstrates an assured understanding of the role and its context within the performance, showing secure credibility and consistency. • Characterisation is effective, showing secure focus and confidence. • Effective rapport and assured communication with audience/other performers, shown through assured ease and awareness throughout.
Level 5	11–12	Sophisticated • Characterisation demonstrates a perceptive understanding of the role and its context within the performance, shown by accomplished credibility and consistency. • Characterisation is skilful and highly engaging, showing accomplished focus and confidence. • Accomplished rapport and sophisticated communication with audience/other performers, shown through highly-effective ease and awareness.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group performance – interpretation and realisation of artistic intentions (performers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited • Demonstrates a superficial interpretation of the text in performance, showing a limited understanding of playwright's intentions. • Performance demonstrates inconsistent understanding of language, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Basic contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group's artistic intentions. Performance overall has limited impact and lacks energy and commitment.
Level 2	3–4	General • Demonstrates an emerging interpretation of the text in performance, showing generally sound understanding of playwright's intentions. • Performance demonstrates generally sound understanding of language, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Generally sound contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group artistic intention. Performance overall has emerging impact through clear energy and commitment.
Level 3	5–7	Competent • Demonstrates a clear interpretation of the text in performance, showing competent understanding of playwright's intentions. • Performance demonstrates competent understanding of language, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Clear contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group artistic intention. Performance overall has clear impact through consistent energy and commitment.
Level 4	8–10	Assured • Demonstrates an effective interpretation of the text in performance, showing an assured understanding of playwright's intentions. • Performance demonstrates a comprehensive understanding of language, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Assured contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group artistic intention. Performance overall has effective impact through comprehensive energy and commitment.
Level 5	11–12	Sophisticated • Demonstrates a sophisticated interpretation of the text in performance, showing a perceptive understanding of playwright's intentions. • Performance demonstrates perceptive understanding of language, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Accomplished contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group artistic intention. Performance overall is dynamic and skilfully creates impact through highly-engaging energy and commitment.

Assessment criteria for group performance: designers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Group performance – design skills (designers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited - Creates a basic and uneven design, demonstrating limited ability to apply design skills. - Design shows basic consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Superficial ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.
Level 2	3–4	General - Creates a generally cohesive design, demonstrating emerging ability to apply design skills. - Design shows generally sound consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Emerging ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.
Level 3	5–7	Competent - Creates a cohesive design, demonstrating secure ability apply design skills. - Design shows consistent consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Competent ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.
Level 4	8–10	Assured - Creates an effective design, demonstrating secure ability to apply design skills. - Design shows assured consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Comprehensive ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.
Level 5	11–12	Sophisticated - Creates an engaging design, demonstrating accomplished ability to apply design skills. - Design shows perceptive consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Accomplished ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Group performance – design in context and communication (designers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited • Design shows a superficial understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Design is inappropriate and/or unsympathetic to the text. • Design shows a limited understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience.
Level 2	3–4	General • Design shows a generally sound understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Design is generally appropriate and/or sympathetic to the text. • Design shows an emerging understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience.
Level 3	5–7	Competent • Design shows competent understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Design is clearly appropriate and/or sympathetic to the text. • Design shows a secure understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience.
Level 4	8–10	Assured • Design shows an assured understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Design is pertinent and fully sympathetic to the text. • Design shows an effective understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience.
Level 5	11–12	Sophisticated • Design shows a perceptive understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Design perceptively integrates with text in an innovative way. • Design shows a sophisticated understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Group performance – interpretation and realisation of artistic intentions (designers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited • Demonstrates a superficial interpretation of the text in performance, showing a limited understanding of playwright's intentions. • Design demonstrates inconsistent understanding of structure, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Limited ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has limited impact, showing a lack of engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 2	3–4	General • Demonstrates an emerging interpretation of the text in performance, showing generally sound understanding of playwright's intentions. • Design demonstrates generally sound understanding of structure, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Generally sound ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has emerging impact, showing some sound engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 3	5–7	Competent • Demonstrates a clear interpretation of the text in performance, showing competent understanding of playwright's intentions. • Design demonstrates competent understanding of structure, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Consistent ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has clear impact, showing consistent engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 4	8–10	Assured • Demonstrates a secure interpretation of the text in performance, shown by secure understanding of playwright's intentions. • Design demonstrates comprehensive understanding of structure, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Assured ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has effective impact, showing comprehensive engagement and commitment to the performance.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Group performance – interpretation and realisation of artistic intentions (designers)
Level 5	11–12	Sophisticated • Demonstrates a sophisticated interpretation of the text in performance, showing a perceptive understanding of playwright's intentions. • Design demonstrates perceptive understanding of structure, style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Accomplished ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall is dynamic and skilfully creates impact, showing full engagement and commitment to the performance.

Assessment criteria for monologue or duologue performance

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Mono/duo performance (performers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–4	Limited • Basic technical control in the use of vocal and physical techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection/gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Performance is often inappropriate or inconsistent, showing a lack of variety, range and control. • Characterisation demonstrates a superficial understanding of the role and its context within the performance. • Superficial rapport and inconsistent communication with audience/other performer, shown through lack of ease and awareness. • Demonstrates a superficial interpretation of the text in performance, showing a limited understanding of playwright's intentions. • Basic realisation of artistic intentions in performance. Performance overall has limited impact and lacks energy and commitment.
Level 2	5–9	General • Emerging technical control in the use of vocal and physical techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection/gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Performance is generally appropriate or consistent, showing emerging variety, range and control. • Characterisation demonstrates an emerging understanding of the role and its context within the performance. • Generally sound rapport and communication with audience/other performer, shown through emerging ease and awareness. • Demonstrates an emerging interpretation of the text in performance, showing a generally sound understanding of playwright's intentions. • Generally sound realisation of artistic intention in performance. Performance overall has emerging impact through some sound energy and commitment.
Level 3	10–14	Competent • Consistent technical control in the use of vocal and physical techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection/gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Performance is appropriate and consistent, showing clear variety range and control. • Characterisation demonstrates a secure understanding of the role and its context within the performance. • Clear rapport and communication with audience/other performer, shown through secure ease and awareness. • Demonstrates a clear interpretation of the text in performance, showing a competent understanding of playwright's intentions. • Clear realisation of artistic intention in performance. Performance overall has clear impact through consistent energy and commitment.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Mono/duo performance (performers)
Level 4	15–19	Assured - Assured technical control in the use of vocal and physical techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection/gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Performance is pertinent and comprehensive, showing effective variety, range and control throughout. - Characterisation demonstrates an assured understanding of the role and its context within the performance. - Effective rapport and assured communication with audience/other performer, shown through assured ease and awareness throughout. - Demonstrates an effective interpretation of the text in performance, showing an assured understanding of playwright's intentions. - Assured realisation of artistic intention in performance. Performance overall has effective impact through comprehensive energy and commitment.
Level 5	20–24	Sophisticated - Accomplished technical control in the use vocal and physical techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection/gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Performance is perceptively integrated, sophisticated and dynamic, showing skilful variety, range and control throughout. - Characterisation demonstrates a perceptive understanding of the role and its context within the performance. - Accomplished rapport and sophisticated communication with audience/other performer, shown through highly-effective ease and awareness. - Demonstrates a sophisticated interpretation of the text in performance, showing a perceptive understanding of playwright's intentions. - Accomplished realisation of artistic intentions in performance. Performance overall is dynamic and skilfully creates impact through highly-engaging energy and commitment.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Mono/duo performance – designers
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–4	Limited - Creates a basic design, demonstrating limited ability to apply design skills. Design is inappropriate and/or unsympathetic to the text. - Design shows basic consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Design shows a limited understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. - Design shows a superficial understanding of its function and purpose within the production. - Limited ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has limited impact, showing a lack of engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 2	5–9	General - Creates a generally appropriate design, demonstrating emerging ability to apply design skills. Design is generally appropriate and/or sympathetic to the text. - Design shows generally sound consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Design shows an emerging understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. - Design shows a generally sound understanding of its function and purpose within the production. - Generally sound ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has emerging impact, showing some sound engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 3	10–14	Competent - Creates a clear design, demonstrating secure ability to apply design skills. Design is clearly appropriate and/or sympathetic to the text. - Design shows consistent consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Design shows a secure understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. - Design shows competent understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. - Consistent ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the production as a whole. Design overall has clear impact, showing consistent engagement and commitment to the performance.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Mono/duo performance – designers
Level 4	15–19	Assured • Creates an effective design, demonstrating secure ability to apply design skills. Design is pertinent and fully sympathetic to the text. • Design shows assured consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. • Design shows an effective understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. • Design shows an assured understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Assured ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has effective impact, showing comprehensive engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 5	20–24	Sophisticated • Creates an engaging design, demonstrating accomplished ability to apply design skills. Design perceptively integrates with text in an innovative way. • Design shows perceptive consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. • Design shows a sophisticated understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. • Design shows a perceptive understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Accomplished ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall is dynamic and skilfully creates impact, showing full engagement and commitment to the performance.

Component 3: Theatre Makers in Practice

Overview

Theatre is a collaborative art form and it is important that students have a clear understanding of how different creative ideas are put into practice. This component requires students to consider, analyse and evaluate how different theatre makers create impact. Throughout this component, students will consider how production ideas and dramatic elements are communicated to an audience from the perspective of a director, a performer and a designer.

Students will critically analyse and evaluate their experience of live performance. As an informed member of the audience they will deconstruct theatrical elements which will help inform their own production choices and develop their own ideas as potential theatre makers.

Students will practically explore texts in order to demonstrate how ideas for performance and production might be realised from page to stage. They will also consider the methodologies of practitioners and interpret texts in order to justify their own ideas for a production concept. Students will research the original performance conditions and gain an understanding of how social, historical and cultural contexts have informed their decisions as theatre makers.

Content

There are **three** areas to be covered.

- 1) A live theatre evaluation.
- 2) Page to stage: realisation of a complete performance text.
- 3) Interpreting **one complete** performance text, in light of **one practitioner** for a contemporary audience.

1) Live Theatre Evaluation

Students will reflect on their experience as an informed member of an audience watching a theatre performance, enabling them to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of performance through analysis and evaluation. When choosing a performance the following criteria should be taken into consideration.

- While both amateur and professional productions are acceptable, it is not acceptable to evaluate the work of other students for this assessment.
- The live theatre performance cannot be a performance text that is on the prescribed list of this specification.
- It should ideally demonstrate a range of production elements e.g. costume, set, sound, and lighting.
- The production should present opportunities for students to discuss the work of key theatre makers, for example directors, performers and designers.
- The production must provide opportunities for students to use a subject-specific vocabulary.

For the purposes of this qualification, live theatre means being a member of the audience in the same performance space as the performers. It does **not** include any performance that is sung-through in its entirety. The performance can be an amateur or professional production as long as the choice enables students to access the demands of this component.

It is desirable for students to see as much live theatre as possible throughout the course, although only **one** performance will be written about in the examination.

Centres are reminded that they must submit a live performance statement to Pearson (please see *page 8* for details). If there are extreme extenuating circumstances regarding the access to live theatre for this component, then centres are required to contact drama.assessment@pearson.com.

Notes

Students are allowed to bring in theatre evaluation notes of up to a maximum of 500 words. These notes must be focused on **one** performance only and include the details of the title, venue and date seen. These notes should help them to demonstrate knowledge and understanding as an informed member of the audience.

These notes may include reference to:

- performers, including performers in specific roles
- design considerations, including the use of costume, set, lighting and sound
- the director's concept/interpretation and the chosen performance style
- impact on the audience, including, specifically, on the student, and how this was achieved
- the use of the theatre space
- how ideas were communicated during the performance.

Sketches, drawings and diagrams may also be included in the notes and used to support the response to the question if required.

No pre-published material, including programmes and photographs, may be taken into the examination or form part of the notes.

Notes may be handwritten or word processed but the total word limit must not be exceeded.

Notes must not be submitted with the examination paper, but retained by the centre and kept until after post-results services deadline.

The notes must be attached to the form provided in *Appendix 2*.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- understand the processes and practices used in 21st-century theatre making
- participate as an informed member of the audience while watching live theatre
- understand and experience the collaborative relationship between various roles in theatre
- understand how choices made by directors, performers and designers influence how meaning and ideas are communicated to an audience
- make critical and evaluative judgements that show understanding of how the meaning of a text might be interpreted and communicated to an audience
- how meaning is conveyed through:
 - the use of performance space and spatial relationships on stage
 - the relationships between performers and audience
 - the performer's vocal and physical interpretation of character
- know, understand and use relevant subject-specific terminology.

Skills

Students must acquire, develop and apply skills in:

- interpreting, analysing and evaluating the work of various theatre makers
- forming critical judgements about live theatre, based on their understanding of drama and theatre

- analysing the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre
- using of subject-specific terminology in a range of contexts.

2) Page to Stage: realisation of one key extract from a performance text

Students must practically explore a performance text (from list A below) to consider how theatrical ideas might be realised in performance and communicated to an audience. They will need to consider how performers and designers use theatrical conventions and dramatic elements to realise ideas from the page to the stage.

Students will respond to an **unseen extract** from their chosen performance text in the examination. They will be asked to consider a possible staging of the selected unseen extract and the intended impact their creative ideas will have on an audience.

The unseen extract will be from a scene or moment that is significant to the text as a whole. Extracts will normally be between 80–110 lines long (this includes spoken dialogue and stage directions). Please note performance texts are not permitted in the examination.

Centres must choose **one** of the following performance texts.

Performance text (List A)	Prescribed edition*
<i>Accidental Death Of An Anarchist</i> , Dario Fo (adapted by Gavin Richards)	Methuen Drama ISBN 9780413156105
<i>Colder Than Here</i> , Laura Wade	Oberon Modern Plays ISBN 9781840024715
<i>Equus</i> , Peter Shaffer	Penguin Classics ISBN 9780141188904
<i>Fences</i> , August Wilson	Penguin Books Ltd (reissue edition 1991) ISBN 9780452264014
<i>Machinal</i> , Sophie Treadwell	Nick Hern Books ISBN 9781854592118
<i>That Face</i> , Polly Stenham	Faber & Faber ISBN 9780571244218

*The prescribed editions will be used to reproduce extracts for examination purposes. Centres are free to choose a different edition for teaching purposes.

Centres are reminded that they must complete a form regarding text choice, please refer to *page 7* for details.

Practical work should include, as appropriate, the exploration of:

- characterisation of key roles including the use of physicality and voice
- staging, levels and proxemics
- stage space
- entrances and exits
- visual and non-verbal forms of communication
- design elements
- relationship between actor and audience
- ways in which the playwright has structured the text and uses elements such as plot, language, form, genre, structure, characterisation and stage directions to communicate ideas
- mood and atmosphere
- performance style and use of theatrical devices
- relevant subject-specific vocabulary.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- make creative decisions and theatrical choices as theatre makers
- explore in depth the ways in which theatre makers collaborate to create theatre by understanding how performers and designers use dramatic elements to communicate meaning and ideas to an audience
- have a knowledge of production values and be able to make clear choices about how a performance text might be realised in performance
- consider how language, genre, form and characterisation might be explored in performance
- consider how elements such as theatrical space, set, staging, lighting, sound, multimedia, masks, costume, puppets and props might be used in performance to communicate meaning to an audience
- know and understand appropriate subject-specific terminology.

Skills

Students must acquire, develop and apply skills in:

- forming critical judgements about the practice of theatre makers based on their understanding of drama and theatre
- responding to texts imaginatively conveying ideas clearly and coherently
- practically exploring the use of voice, movement, staging and characterisation
- practically exploring ways in which the ideas of key theatre makers are realised in performance
- the use of an appropriate subject-specific terminology
- analysing the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre.

3) Interpreting one performance text, in the light of one practitioner for a contemporary audience

Students must practically explore **a complete performance text** (from list B on the next page) in the light of a chosen practitioner (from the list on the next page) in order to outline and justify their ideas for a production concept. They will need to develop an integral understanding of the text as a whole in order to interpret it for a contemporary audience. Students will assume the role of a director and will need to outline and justify how different theatre makers and theatrical elements work alongside the methodologies of a recognised theatre practitioner. The practitioner chosen for this component needs to be different from the one studied in Component 1 (see *pages 6 and 7*).

Students must also research the original performance conditions and gain knowledge and understanding of the social, historical and cultural factors that are central to the context of the original text.

Interpreting a performance text may or may not include changes to performance style, historical period or setting. However, whilst changes and edits to the structure of the text are allowed, it is not an opportunity to cut the language or alter the meaning of the original text.

It is also important that students have an appreciation of the original aims and intentions of the playwright. In whatever way the production is interpreted by the student, the audience will always be contemporary (a 21st-century audience).

Students may prepare a director's script that will help them consider how their chosen text might be interpreted as a complete performance.

When considering how their chosen performance text might be interpreted and staged in the light of a practitioner students should consider:

- their intended audience and an appropriate theatrical venue/space
- staging and visual impact
- how the use of design elements such as set, lighting, sound, costume, multimedia, masks, props and puppets might help to communicate ideas to an audience
- the acting style of key roles including the use of characterisation, vocal expression and movement
- the original performance conditions and the historical, social and cultural context of the text.

Practical work should, as appropriate, include exploration of:

- characterisation of key roles
- staging and space
- visual communication
- design elements
- relationship between actor and audience
- ways in which the playwright has structured the text and uses elements such as plot, language, form, structure, characterisation and stage directions to communicate ideas to an audience
- mood and atmosphere
- performance style and theatrical devices
- practitioner methodology
- historical, social and cultural context and its relevance to themselves and a contemporary audience
- relevant subject-specific vocabulary.

Centres must choose **one** of the following performance texts to study.

Performance text (List B)	Recommended edition
<i>Antigone</i> , Sophocles (adapted by Don Taylor)	Methuen ISBN 9780413776044
<i>Doctor Faustus</i> , Christopher Marlowe*†	Norton & Company ISBN 9780393977547
<i>Hedda Gabler</i> , Henrik Ibsen (adapted by Richard Eyre)	Nick Hern Books ISBN 9781854598424
<i>Lysistrata</i> , Aristophanes (translated by Alan H. Sommerstein)†	Penguin Classics ISBN 9780140448146
<i>The Maids</i> , Jean Genet (translated by Bernard Frechtman)	Faber & Faber ISBN: 9780571251148
<i>The School for Scandal</i> , Richard Brinsley Sheridan	Dover Thrift ISBN 9780486266879
<i>The Tempest</i> , William Shakespeare	Oxford School Shakespeare ISBN: 9780198325000
<i>Waiting for Godot</i> , Samuel Beckett	Faber & Faber ISBN 9780571229116
<i>Woyzeck</i> , Georg Büchner (translated by John Mackendrick)†	Berg Publishing ISBN 9780413388209

* This edition has two versions of the text and centres should use Text A only

† These texts are available as PDF downloads from the Pearson [website](#).

In the examination the page numbers from both the recommended editions and the PDF versions will be given.

Students **must** take clean copies of list B texts into the examination. Students will respond to an **unseen named section** from their chosen performance text in the examination.

The **unseen named section** will normally be between 90-110 lines long.

It is strongly recommended that the editions above are used by centres as these will be used to specify page references for each **unseen named section** in the examination.

The centre must ensure that only clean copies are used in the examination. Clean copies of prescribed texts must be checked prior to entering the examination and if texts are found to not be clean, then the copy must be taken from the student. Any infringements of this requirement found during the examination must be reported to Pearson and will be treated as a malpractice issue.

Practitioners

The practitioner chosen from the list below should be different to the one studied in Component 1.

Antonin Artaud	Kneehigh
Bertolt Brecht	Joan Littlewood
Steven Berkoff	Punchdrunk
Complicite	Constantin Stanislavski

Centres are reminded that they must complete a form regarding text and practitioner choices, please refer to *page 7* for details.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- explore a complete and substantial set text from the viewpoint of a theatre director
- make creative decisions and theatrical choices as a theatre director
- demonstrate an understanding of production methods used to communicate a directorial concept and interpretation to an audience
- explore and develop ideas that will shape a complete production concept and interpretation
- understand how directors communicate ideas to an audience and how the meaning of a text might be interpreted and communicated to an audience
- participate in practical exploration that considers the ways in which the playwright has structured the text and uses plot, language, form, structure, characterisation and stagecraft to communicate ideas to an audience
- consider how the application of dramatic elements (for example, physicality, vocal expression, set, sound, light, costume, masks, puppets, props and space) contribute to the development and shaping of ideas in performance
- develop an understanding and appreciation of how practitioner theory and practice has influenced the development of drama and theatre
- consider how the work of a chosen theatre practitioner might inform or influence a production concept of their chosen text
- explore the potential for staging texts, taking into consideration any relevant stage directions
- develop an understanding of historical, social and cultural contexts including the original performance conditions
- know and understanding appropriate subject-specific terminology.

Students must acquire knowledge and understanding of how their chosen practitioner has used the following to convey meaning through:

- the social and historical contexts that shaped the theatre practice
- the ideas, theatrical purpose, practice and working methodologies underpinning their work
- the realisation of their artistic intention
- the use of theatrical style and conventions
- collaboration with and influence on other practitioners
- how the relationship with audiences is defined in theory and then carried out in practice.

Skills

Students must acquire, develop and apply skills in:

- forming critical judgements about the practice of theatre makers based on their understanding of drama and theatre
- responding to texts imaginatively conveying ideas clearly and coherently
- practically exploring the use of voice, movement, staging and characterisation
- practically exploring ways in which the ideas of the director are interpreted in performance
- the use of an appropriate subject-specific terminology
- analysing the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre
- applying practitioner methodology to their own dramatic interpretations
- using research to develop ideas in a variety of contexts.